




# World History

## Chapter 1 ( Part 2 )

## The Renaissance And Reformation (1350-1600)

## Lesson 3

## The Italian Renaissance

Name : .....

Grade : 10 / .....

# What Should I Remember?

## MAIN POINT 1: The Renaissance (about 1350–1550)

- **Renaissance** means "**rebirth.**" It began in Italy and later spread to the rest of Europe.
- People felt that ancient Greek and Roman culture was being born again.

### Three main characteristics

- **1. Urban and secular.** Strong city-states grew. Wealth led to a secular (worldly) viewpoint.
- **2. Recovery and classical antiquity.** Italy recovered from the plague, political instability, and weaker Church power. People became interested again in ancient Greece and Rome (classical antiquity).
- **3. Individual ability.** Alberti said, "Men can do all things if they will." The ideal was a well-rounded person, like **Leonardo da Vinci** (VIHN-chee): painter, sculptor, architect, inventor, and mathematician.

### Who felt the Renaissance?

- The wealthy upper classes (a small group) joined in actively.
- Ordinary people felt it indirectly. They saw new art in churches, homes, and public buildings.

## MAIN POINT 2: Italy's City-States, Wars, and Ideas

### A. City-states and trade

- No strong king ruled Italy, so city-states stayed independent. The main ones were Milan, Venice, and Florence.
- They grew rich from trade. After the Crusades, merchants set up trading centers in eastern ports and bought silks, sugar, and spices.

### B. Three leading cities

- **Milan:** rich from trade and an efficient tax system. The Visconti family were dukes. After the last Visconti died in 1447, **Francesco Sforza**, leader of **mercenaries** (soldiers paid to fight), became duke.
- **Venice:** a link between Asia and Western Europe. Officially a **republic** led by an elected **doge**, but a few wealthy merchant-aristocrats really ruled.
- **Florence:** In **1434**, **Cosimo de' Medici** (MEH-duh-chee) took control. The Medici family ruled from behind the scenes, using wealth and influence. Their patronage (support for artists) made Florence the cultural center.
  - Late 1400s: economic decline, because English and Flemish cloth makers took away profits.
  - Savonarola, a preacher, attacked Medici corruption. People followed him, but later grew tired of his strict rules. In **1498** he was sentenced to death for heresy (going against Church teaching). The Medici returned.
  - Art: Gozzoli painted frescoes (wall paintings) for the Medici in 1459. Bramante began the dome of St. Peter's Basilica, and Michelangelo completed it.

### C. The Italian Wars

- Strong monarchies in Europe wanted Italy's riches.
- In 1494, King Charles VIII of France invaded and occupied Naples.
- France and Spain then fought in Italy for 30 years.
- In 1527, unpaid troops of Spain's King Charles I looted Rome (the Sack of Rome).
- The wars ended, and Spain became dominant in Italy.

### D. Machiavelli (MA-kee-uh-VEH-lee)

- He wrote **The Prince** about how to acquire and keep political power (his central thesis).
- He said morality has little to do with politics. Human nature is self-centered, and a prince acts for the state.
- His ideas influenced later leaders.

## Question 1 : Choose the correct answer.

1. What does the word "renaissance" mean?

A. Reform
B. Rebirth
C. Revolution
D. Rule

2. Which is one of the three main characteristics of the Renaissance?

A. One strong king ruled all of Italy.
B. The Church became more powerful.
C. A growing urban society with a secular, worldly viewpoint.
D. People lost interest in ancient culture.

3. Why is Leonardo da Vinci an example of a well-rounded person?

A. He was a painter, sculptor, architect, inventor, and mathematician.
B. He was the king of Italy.
C. He led the army of Milan.
D. He wrote The Prince.

4. Why did many independent city-states exist in Italy?

A. The Church ruled all of Italy.
B. Venice had conquered them.
C. Spain protected them.
D. Italy had no single strong ruler.

5. Why was Milan one of the richest city-states?

A. It had a large navy.
B. It grew rich from trade and had an efficient tax system.
C. It was ruled by an elected doge.
D. It sold cloth to England.

6. Which statement about Venice is correct?

A. Officially it was a republic, but wealthy merchant-aristocrats really ran it.
B. It was ruled by the Sforza dukes.
C. It had no leader.
D. It was a poor city with little trade.

7. How did the Medici family rule Florence?

A. As elected doges
B. As mercenary soldiers
C. As dukes of Milan
D. From behind the scenes, using their wealth and influence

8. Why did people become tired of Savonarola?

A. He gave power back to the Medici.
B. His rules were very strict.
C. He joined the Spanish army.
D. He raised taxes in Milan.

9. What happened in 1527 when the unpaid troops of Charles I of Spain reached Rome?

A. They made peace with the pope.
B. They sailed to Venice.
C. They entered the city and looted it.
D. They crowned Charles VIII.

10. What was Machiavelli's central thesis in The Prince?

A. How to acquire and keep political power
B. How rulers should follow Christian moral principles
C. How to build a great dome
D. How to trade silk and spices

## Question 2 : True ( T ) or False ( F ) Questions:

1. The Renaissance began in Italy and later spread to other parts of Europe. ( )
2. In the Middle Ages, one strong king ruled all of Italy and united the city-states. ( )
3. Donato Bramante began the dome of St. Peter's Basilica, and Michelangelo completed the design. ( )
4. Ordinary people were not affected by the Renaissance in any way. ( )
5. Francesco Sforza was the last Visconti ruler of Milan. ( )
6. Cosimo de' Medici took control of Florence in 1434. ( )
8. The Sack of Rome in 1527 left Spain as a dominant force in Italy. ( )
9. After Savonarola was sentenced to death in 1498, the Medici family never returned to power. ( )
10. Machiavelli believed that human nature is basically self-centered. ( )